# PREreview: Open preprint reviews for all researchers

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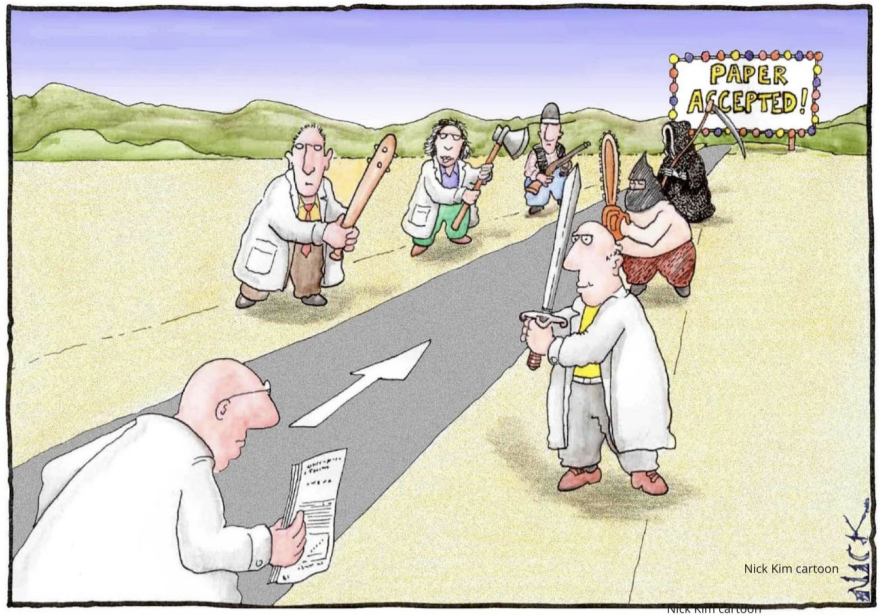
# What is Peer Review?

Peer review is the evaluation of work by one or more people with similar competencies as the producers of the work. It functions as a form of self-regulation by **qualified members of a profession** within the relevant field.

—Wikipedia

https://twitter.com/digitalsci/status/781860071831642113




Most scientists regarded the new streamlined peer-review process as "quite an improvement."

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# Peer review is inequitable and unsustainable

- The pool of people called to review/people willing to do so is small and often insufficient for the number of review requests
- The composition of the reviewer pool is homogenous across many dimensions
- Most reviewers are male, mid- or late-career researchers selected by journal editors as “experts” in their field
- Yet, most have never received any formal training in conducting peer review
- Despite the vital work that peer reviewers do, it most often goes unpaid and unrecognized.

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# We work to challenge the status quo for the benefit of all

PREreview's mission is to bring more **equity** and **transparency** to scholarly peer review by supporting and empowering communities of researchers, particularly those at early stages of their career (ECRs) and historically excluded, to review preprints in a process that is **rewarding** to them.

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# PREreview imagines more equitable and broader participation in peer review... and here is how ORCID is helping us to do that

- **Open** - Our work is open, transparent, and non-proprietary.
- **Trust** - Log-in via ORCID ensures accountability and provides clarity in research contributions.
- **Inclusive -** Contributions to peer review via PREreview are barrier free, extending the pool of reviewers to those traditionally excluded.
- **Recognition** - ORCID auto-update allows public peer review activity to be added seamlessly to reviewers profiles, building recognition and credit for this work.

# PREreview by the numbers

## All-time

**2,736**
PREreviewers

**887**
PREreviews

## Since launching our ORCID integration in February 2024

**57**
Connected ORCID profiles

**100**
Peer review entries on ORCID

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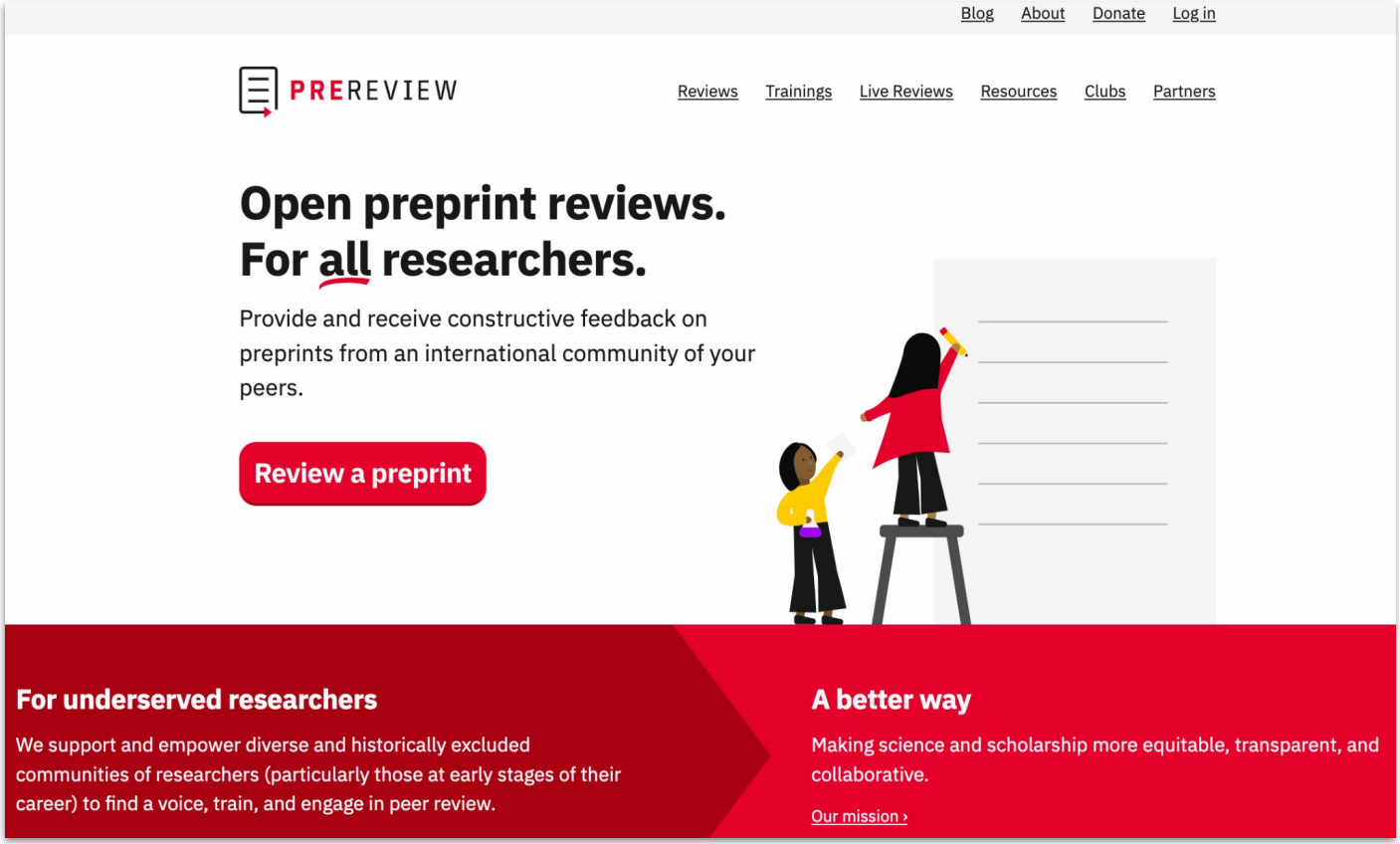
# PREreview Platform Demo

prereview.org



hhmi | Howard Hughes Medical Institute

# Transparent & Accountable Peer Review

*Training Pilot*

Anna Hatch, PhD
May 30, 2024

## Program coordinators

**Anna Hatch**
**Program Officer, HHMI**

**Michele Avissar-Whiting**
**Program Officer, HHMI**

**Iratxe Puebla**
**Director, Make Data Count**

**Jessica Polka**
**Open Science Program Director, Astera Institute**

# Pilot overview

11 graduate students and 5 postdocs participating from 9 HHMI labs

Six-month training duration

Each participant completes 2 peer review reports on preprints with the support of their mentor

# Why peer review on preprints?

**No barrier to participate**
Early-career researchers can participate without relying on an invitation by an editor

**Focus on the science**
Preprints allow an evaluation of the science without gatekeeping

**Benefits to the authors**
Feedback on a version of the paper the authors are still working on

**Benefits to the community**
Transparency provides important context and promotes trust in science.

# Pilot objectives

The pilot seeks to enable **trainees** to:

- Articulate the **purposes of peer review**, how it operates, and the **different models of peer review** available to evaluate scientific manuscripts
- Appraise scientific manuscripts independently and develop **constructive and focused feedback**
- Identify **conflicts of interest and biases**
- Develop a portfolio of **public peer reviews**
- Learn how to highlight **peer reviews in their CV and in job or grant applications**

# Pilot objectives

The pilot seeks to enable **mentors** to:

- Demonstrate commitment to **HHMI's core values**
- Develop individuals by helping trainees **hone their critical peer review skills**
- Foster an engaged **lab environment**
- Gain recognition as a mentor who **prioritizes professional development**
- **Attract new trainees** to their labs

# Timeline & deliverables

## January - February

- 4 online training modules
- 2 online practice sessions

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## July

- Program certificate for trainees and mentors

# Working with trainees

Mentors will support trainees in writing 4 peer reviews for preprints

# Posting Peer Review Reports

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Reviews Requests Trainings Live Reviews Resources Clubs

## HHMI Transparent and Accountable Peer Review Training Pilot

HHMI is a biomedical research organization and philanthropy that supports a vibrant community of researchers, educators, students, and professionals. Together, we're unlocking the fundamentals of biology and building an open, inclusive future for science.

As part of a newly developed training pilot, participating graduate students and postdocs in HHMI labs will learn to conduct peer review in a manner that is constructive and transparent.

**Club leads**

Anna Hatch and Michele Avissar-Whiting

## PREreviews

**Lawngreen Parrot** and **1 other author** reviewed "Full-length direct RNA sequencing uncovers stress-granule dependent RNA decay upon cellular stress"

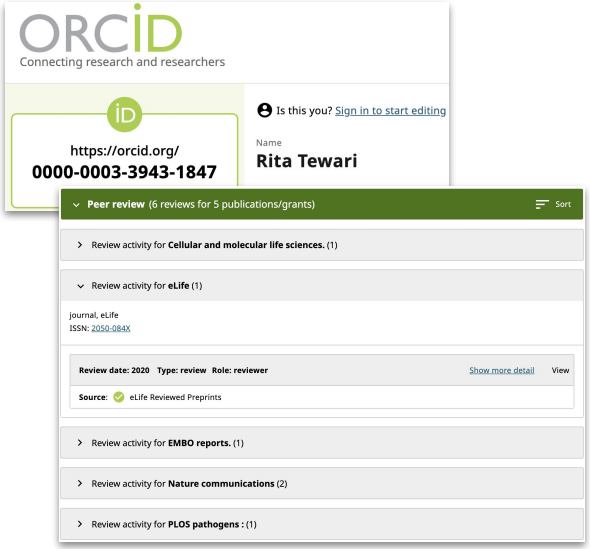
April 20, 2024 bioRxiv

**Hickory Butterfly** and **1 other author** reviewed "Full-length direct RNA sequencing uncovers stress-granule dependent RNA decay upon cellular stress"

April 19, 2024 bioRxiv

# Highlighting review activity with ORCID

PREreview can now share a user's review activity to their ORCID profile if the user wants, enabling recognition for the scholarly work.



# Next steps

- Analyze the outcomes of the pilot
- Incorporate learnings to improve the training
- Scale up the program

# Where might we go together next?

- Sharing more information about **PREreview training** to ORCID profiles
- Providing information related to **PREreview Clubs** publications
- Improved information about PREreviews
- Other emerging needs as they arise - we constantly assess **community needs** via design sprints and via various feedback channels

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# What you can do next with PREreview & ORCID

- ★ Create an account on PREreview.org, using your ORCID iD, and fill in your profile
- ★ Visit your "My Details" page and click on "Connect ORCID profile." to allow PREreview.org to share your public review activity with ORCID
- ★ Start reviewing! Choose between copy/pasting in your review, filling out a basic template, or following our Structured Review prompts
- ★ Look into PREreview Open Reviewers training for your organization or join our next community workshop (prereview.org/trainings)
- ★ Start a PREreview Club or join an existing one (prereview.org/clubs)
- ★ Join the conversation on the PREreview Slack Community (bit.ly/PREreview-Slack)

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# Join us at PREreview!

bit.ly/PREreview-newsletter

bit.ly/PREreview-Slack

Email us at community@prereview.org

Twitter @PREreview_ | Mastodon @prereview@mas.to | BlueSky @prereview.bsky.social

# Thank You!

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